

Paúl Arias Medina

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ABOUT

Researcher at the Interdisciplinary Department of Space and Population, Universidad de Cuenca (Ecuador), and lecturer at the Faculty of Psychology, where I teach statistics and quantitative research methodology. PhD candidate and fellow in the Behavioural Economics and Engineering (BEE) group at KU Leuven (Belgium). Local coordinator of CIRCLE, funded by VLIR-UOS, in collaboration with KU Leuven, UGent, ESPOL, FCD and ODJ. Primary research interest: corruption at the individual level, how citizens perceive, justify, tolerate, or reject it, combining cognitive and behavioural frameworks with experiments. Background in psychometrics and measurement validation, and in international migration and education.

EDUCATION

KU Leuven, Belgium	2022–present
Ph.D. Candidate · Behavioural Engineering and Economics	
Universiteit Antwerpen, Belgium	2015–2016
MSc in Development Studies · With great distinction	
TEC Monterrey, Mexico	2014
Specialisation in Risk Management	
Universidad de Cuenca, Ecuador	2008–2013
Economist (B.Sc.)	

ACADEMIC POSITIONS

Local Coordinator, CIRCLE Project (VLIR-UOS TEAM)	2022–2027
Universidad de Cuenca / KU Leuven / Ghent University	
PhD Fellow, Behavioural Engineering and Economics	2022–present
KU Leuven, Belgium	
Researcher and Lecturer · Faculty of Psychology	2016–present
Universidad de Cuenca, Ecuador	
Visiting Fellow	Jan–Feb 2019
KU Leuven, Belgium	
Risk Analyst	2014–2015
Mutualista Azuay, Ecuador	

PUBLICATIONS (CHRONOLOGICAL)

2026. Adaptación psicométrica del modelo de dignidad, imagen y honor en Cuenca, Ecuador

Quizhpe-Espinosa, M. J., Yanacallo-Sigcha, J. S., & Arias-Medina, P. (2026). *Revista Ecuatoriana de Psicología*, 9(24), 223–239. <https://doi.org/10.33996/repso.v9i24.237>

2025. Psychometric properties of the Zung Self-Applied Anxiety Scale in an Ecuadorian sample

Delgado-Quezada, T. L., Peña-Contreras, E., Cali-Ramón, D., & Arias-Medina, P. (2025). *Maskana*, 16(2), 27–43.
<https://doi.org/10.18537/mskn.16.02.02>

2025. Are public service motivation and social value orientation related to bribery? Evidence from a developing country

Cali, D., Merchán, E., & Arias-Medina, P. (2025). *XVIII Multidisciplinary International Congress on Science and Technology*.

2024. Psychometric analysis of the Spanish version of the Identity Distress Scale in Ecuadorian emerging adults

Cordero-Hermida, F., Sacoto, J. D., Sinchi, E., & Arias-Medina, P. (2024). *Psychology in Russia: State of the Art*, 17(4), 109–125. <https://doi.org/10.11621/pir.2024.0406>

2024. Estructura factorial latente de diez modelos de la Escala Hospitalaria de Ansiedad y Depresión (HADS) en una muestra de adultos jóvenes ecuatorianos

Arias-Medina, P., & Lima-Castro, S. (2024). *Revista Iberoamericana de Diagnóstico y Evaluación Psicológica*, 72(2), 191–204. <https://doi.org/10.21865/RIDEP72.02.14>

2024. El inventario de funcionamiento ejecutivo para niños (CHEXI): evidencia psicométrica en una muestra de escolares ecuatorianos

Tacuri-Reino, D., Bernal-Arellano, W. M., & Arias-Medina, P. (2024). *Avances en Psicología*, 32(1), e2949.
<https://doi.org/10.31620/AP.32.01/e2949>

2023. Propiedades psicométricas de las escalas de actitudes emprendedoras para estudiantes y de inteligencia emocional de Wong y Law en universitarios ecuatorianos

Ortíz-Ochoa, W. A., Tacuri-Reino, D., Arias-Medina, P., & Domínguez-Gómez, M. (2023). *Maskana*, 14(2), 19–28.
<https://doi.org/10.18537/mskn.14.02.02>

2021. Factor structure, measurement invariance and psychometric properties of the WHOQOL-BREF in the Ecuadorian context

Lima-Castro, S., Arias-Medina, P., Bueno-Pacheco, A., Peña-Contreras, E., Aguilar-Sizer, M., & Cabrera-Vélez, M. (2021). *Psicologia: Reflexão e Crítica*, 34(1), Article 29. <https://doi.org/10.1186/s41155-021-00194-9>

2021. Propiedades psicométricas de la versión en español del Test de Compromiso con la Vida en personas con discapacidad física

Lima-Castro, S., Arias-Medina, P., Blanco, V., & Vázquez, F. L. (2021). *Revista Iberoamericana de Diagnóstico y Evaluación Psicológica*, 60(3), 15–26. <https://doi.org/10.21865/RIDEP60.3.02>

2021. Propiedades psicométricas del Cuestionario de Apoyo Social Funcional Duke-UNK-11 en adultos ecuatorianos

Aguilar-Sizer, M., Lima-Castro, S., Arias-Medina, P., Peña-Contreras, E., Cabrera-Vélez, M., & Bueno-Pacheco, A. (2021). *Eureka*, 18(1), 55–71.

2021. Teletrabajo, trabajo no remunerado y violencia de género en el Ecuador durante la pandemia por COVID-19

Peña-Contreras, E., Calderón, M. del C., Arias-Medina, P., & Sacaquirin-Rivadeneira, C. (2021). *Maskana*, 12(2), 11–18. <https://doi.org/10.18537/mskn.12.02.02>

2021. Calidad de vida y variables asociadas: Reflexiones, concepciones teóricas y los desafíos de su evaluación

Lima-Castro, S., Bueno-Pacheco, A., Arias-Medina, P., Aguilar-Sizer, M., Cabrera-Vélez, M., Cordero-Hermida, F., Peña-Contreras, E., & Racines-Jerves, D. (Eds.). (2021). *Calidad de vida y variables asociadas*. Casa Editora, Universidad del Azuay. [Book]

2020. Estructura factorial, invarianza y propiedades psicométricas de la Escala de Autoestima de Rosenberg en el contexto ecuatoriano

Bueno-Pacheco, A., Lima-Castro, S., Arias-Medina, P., Peña-Contreras, E., Aguilar-Sizer, M., & Cabrera-Vélez, M. (2020). *Revista Iberoamericana de Diagnóstico y Evaluación Psicológica*, 56(3), 87–100. <https://doi.org/10.21865/RIDEP56.3.07>

2020. Propiedades psicométricas de la Escala Breve de Resiliencia (BRS) en el contexto ecuatoriano

Peña-Contreras, E., Lima-Castro, S., Arias-Medina, P., Bueno-Pacheco, A., Aguilar-Sizer, M., & Cabrera-Vélez, M. (2020). *Revista Evaluar*, 20(3), 83–98. <https://doi.org/10.35670/1667-4545.v20.n3.31715>

2020. What money can't buy: Educational aspirations and international migration in Ecuador

Arias-Medina, P., & Rivera-Ullauri, M. J. (2020). *Migration Letters*, 17(5), 681–693. <https://doi.org/10.59670/ml.v17i5.1002>

2020. Evaluación de la calidad de los servicios públicos del Desarrollo Infantil Integral MIES

Arias-Medina, P., Peña-Contreras, E., Aguilar-Sizer, M., & Calderón, M. del C. (2020). *Evaluación de la calidad de los servicios públicos del Desarrollo Infantil Integral MIES*. Universidad de Cuenca. SENADI-2021-6008. [Institutional report]

2019. Adaptation and validation of the Gratitude Questionnaire GQ-6 for the Ecuadorian context

Cabrera-Vélez, M., Lima-Castro, S., Peña-Contreras, E., Aguilar-Sizer, M., Bueno-Pacheco, A., & Arias-Medina, P. (2019). *Aviação Psicológica*, 18(2), 129–137. <https://doi.org/10.15689/ap.2019.1802.15689.03>

2019. Aproximación a un modelo de bienestar en adultos ecuatorianos

Lima-Castro, S., Peña-Contreras, E., Aguilar-Sizer, M., Bueno-Pacheco, A., & Arias-Medina, P. (2019). *Revista Iberoamericana de Diagnóstico y Evaluación Psicológica*, 51(2), 5–18. <https://doi.org/10.21865/RIDEP51.2.01>

2017. Fiabilidad y validez de la Escala del Continuum de Salud Mental (MHC-SF) en el contexto ecuatoriano

Peña-Contreras, E., Lima-Castro, S., Bueno-Pacheco, A., Aguilar-Sizer, M., Keyes, C. L. M., & Arias-Medina, P. (2017). *Ciencias Psicológicas*, 11(2), 223–232. <https://doi.org/10.22235/cp.v11i2.1499>

2017. Bienestar subjetivo y formación de cuidadores de adultos mayores

Bueno-Pacheco, A., Peña-Contreras, E., Arias-Medina, P., Aguilar-Sizer, M., & Cabrera-Vélez, M. (2017). *Acción Pedagógica*, 26(1), 130–147.

FORTHCOMING

Inside a multidisciplinary grounded-theory project on corruption in Ecuador: navigating and negotiating challenges [forthcoming]

Rivera, M. J., Rojas, A., Sucozhañay, D., & Arias-Medina, P. *In press*.

Propiedades psicométricas del AUDIT en trabajadores del sistema público de salud de la provincia del Azuay, Ecuador [forthcoming]

Delgado-Quezada, T. L., Peña-Contreras, E., Yanza-Martínez, G. A., & Arias-Medina, P. *Nuna Yachay*. *In press*.

UNDER REVIEW

Is, should, and culture: wording effects in cultural-norm scale measurement [under review]

Arias-Medina, P.

On the comparability of regional survey data: a measurement invariance analysis of Ecuador's Violence Against Women Survey [under review]

Arias-Medina, P.

Lógicas de favoritismo y confianza en redes familiares en contextos de corrupción en los Andes ecuatorianos [under review]

Lupercio, P., Suárez, S., Chapa, T., Zhimnay, C., & Arias-Medina, P.

Integrating computational topic modeling with qualitative interviewing: what online and offline arenas contribute to mixed methods understanding of corruption discourse *[under review]*

Arias-Medina, P., Chapa, T., & Dewitte, S.

A conceptual replication of a corruption coordination game in Ecuador *[under review]*

Arias-Medina, P., Rhodes, L., Sarmiento, J. P., & Dewitte, S.

"Not corruption" makes more things corrupt: how negation widens fuzzy category boundaries *[under review]*

Arias-Medina, P., Germeys, F., & Dewitte, S.

Percepción social de la corrupción desde la experiencia estudiantil universitaria *[under review]*

Salinas, A., Ordoñez, L., & Arias-Medina, P.

¿Modelo reflectivo o índice formativo? Evidencia psicométrica de la Escala de Riesgo Suicida de Plutchik en una muestra clínica ecuatoriana *[under review]*

Sacaquirin-Rivadeneira, C., Merchán, S., & Arias-Medina, P.

Psychometric validation of scales for autonomy support and psychological control in Ecuadorian adolescents *[under review]*

Palacios, M. D., Conforme, G., & Arias-Medina, P.

Evidencia psicométrica de la Escala de Ansiedad de Hamilton en una muestra clínica institucionalizada *[under review]*

Sacaquirin-Rivadeneira, C., Quizhpe, M. J., & Arias-Medina, P.

Psychometric evidence of the Beck Depression Inventory-II in a hospital-based clinical sample in Ecuador: factor analysis and item response theory *[under review]*

Sacaquirin-Rivadeneira, C., & Arias-Medina, P.

Neither Corrupt nor Clean: Logics of Contestation in Clientelism Exchange *[under review]*

Arias-Medina, P. [Book chapter]

WORK IN PROGRESS

Does ethnicity moderate corruption deals and punishments? Discrimination in cooperative and extortive corruption *[in progress]*

An experimental design on gender and norms in Ecuador *[in progress]*

Vertical and horizontal trust and its link with beliefs of institutional efficacy *[in progress]*

Measuring bribery tolerance through neutralization techniques: an experimental test using Bayesian Truth Serum *[in progress]*

SELECTED PRESENTATIONS

2026. On the understanding of corruption: online and offline data to provide a fuller picture

VIII Academia against Corruption in the Americas (ACA). April 15, 2026, Quito, Ecuador. Paper presenter.

2026. Does ethnicity moderate corruption deals and punishments?

Bogotá Experimental Economics Conference (BEEC) 2026. January 15–16, 2026, Pontificia Universidad Javeriana, Bogotá. Poster.

2024. A cognitive perspective on corruption and its boundaries

Interdisciplinary Corruption Research Network (ICRN). Vienna, Austria.

2024. A grounded theory of corruption in Ecuador: preliminary results from 3 major cities

ICRN. Lisbon, Portugal. With Chapa, T.

2024. Salud mental con pandemia: un estudio de la invarianza de medición

ONE-HEALTH Symposium. Quito, Ecuador.

2021. Structural validity of an instrument for the evaluation of Irlen Syndrome

XV International Symposium of Psycholinguistics. With Bernal-Arellano, M. & Tacuri, D.

2019. Examining the development agenda of three Andean countries using quantitative text analysis

VII REDU Congress, Ibarra, Ecuador. Research poster. [Best poster award]

2018. Las aspiraciones educativas en contextos de migración internacional: una aplicación de métodos mixtos

VI ELMCS, Cuenca, Ecuador.

2018. The educational aspirations and expectations of children of transnational families

Symposium: Exploring New Links Between Transnational Migration and Education. Antwerp, Belgium.

2017. La migración y el cambio cultural en el cantón Sigüig, Ecuador

V REDU Congress, Cuenca, Ecuador. With Pesántez, B.

TEACHING

Statistics

Undergraduate & Master's in Psychology, Universidad de Cuenca

Research Methodology

Undergraduate, Faculty of Psychology, Universidad de Cuenca

Observational and Correlational Methods

Honours Programme (in English), Universidad de Cuenca

Development Theories

Undergraduate, Faculty of Economics, Universidad de Cuenca

Macroeconomics

Undergraduate, Faculty of Economics, Universidad de Cuenca

AWARDS AND RECOGNITION

Best research poster award · VII REDU Congress · Ibarra, Ecuador

2019

Visiting Fellow · KU Leuven

Jan–Feb 2019

VLIR-UOS scholarship · MSc in Development Studies

2015–2016

SOFTWARE

R · SPSS · STATA · ATLAS.ti